NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



Open Crossing

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

Open Crossing

A nameless soul. You do not learn its story; you write it.

It came to the river without a name, without a coin, without a face anyone would remember. It has forgotten most of what it was. Even the old ferryman, who knows every soul by the weight of it in his boat, could not say who it had been. He did not refuse it; he simply did not see it, and it waited on the near shore until the Ferrymen did.

What remains are echoes. Sometimes, when the mist moves, there is a lantern left burning in a window, as if someone were still expected home. A bridge crossed every morning: the same planks, the same river underneath. An old woman selling chestnuts in the snow, her hands black from the coals. Water carried a long way for someone who never said thank you. An anger the soul once mistook for strength. And a ferryman, another one, who would not take its coin.

These echoes belong to no single life. They are what the river keeps of everyone it has ever carried, and this soul will wear whichever of them you give it. Every Open Crossing is a different person. Its Book begins empty; by the Far Shore it will be the only story the soul has.



What the Ferrymen know

Memory Sites call to it like half-familiar rooms, and each gives +2 Light. There is no Key Memory to find. There is only the Book, and what you write in it.

Twist: Memory Sites give +2 Light.



Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach: page I, *Who I Was* (Reach I); page II, *What I Did* (Reach II); page III, *What I Carry* (Reach III). Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which complete a sentence about the soul's life.

Inscribing. When a card Resonates, you may inscribe it if the slot shown on the card is still empty on the page of the Reach the soul is in. A **Key Memory** may be inscribed whenever it is played face up, Resonating or not. To inscribe, put the card in its slot with photo corners instead of discarding it; it stays there for the rest of the game. Oblivion cards and Burned cards cannot be inscribed.

Page rewards. Each page pays a small reward for each pair of neighbouring slots: **Place + Person**, **Person + Deed** and **Deed + Feeling**. When an inscription fills the second slot of a pair, do that pair's reward at once. One card can complete two pairs (a Person inscribed next to a Place and a Deed): do both. Each reward happens once per page; tick its box in the Book. The rewards are printed on each page:

Chapter Blessing. When all 4 slots of a page are filled (3 for the Garland Girl), the page also gives one Chapter Blessing at once (only once per page). The Blessing is not chosen. Check these in order and do the first one that is possible:

If the soul has at least one Fracture: remove 1 Fracture (from the highest well).

Otherwise, if any space has Black Water: remove the Black Water token closest ahead of the soul from the game.

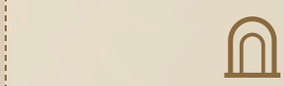
Otherwise, if the forgotten pile has any cards: move the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

Otherwise nothing happens.

Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners into the photo corners. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...



PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

I loved...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I once...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

and ever since I have carried...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ PLACE + PERSON
Place 1 Root.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Bloom 1 Root.

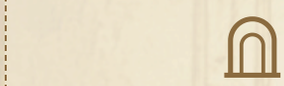
☐ DEED + FEELING
Gain 2 Light.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐☐☐

II · What I Did

At...



PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ PLACE + PERSON
Banish the nearest Shade.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Drain the nearest Black Water.

☐ DEED + FEELING
Untie 1 knot on the fullest thread (if tied, you choose).

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



☐ PLACE + PERSON
Return the newest forgotten card to the discard pile.

☐ PERSON + DEED
Mend 1 Fracture.

☐ DEED + FEELING
The soul steps forward now, if the next space is Lit.

☐ Chapter Blessing (full page)

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

The Far Shore

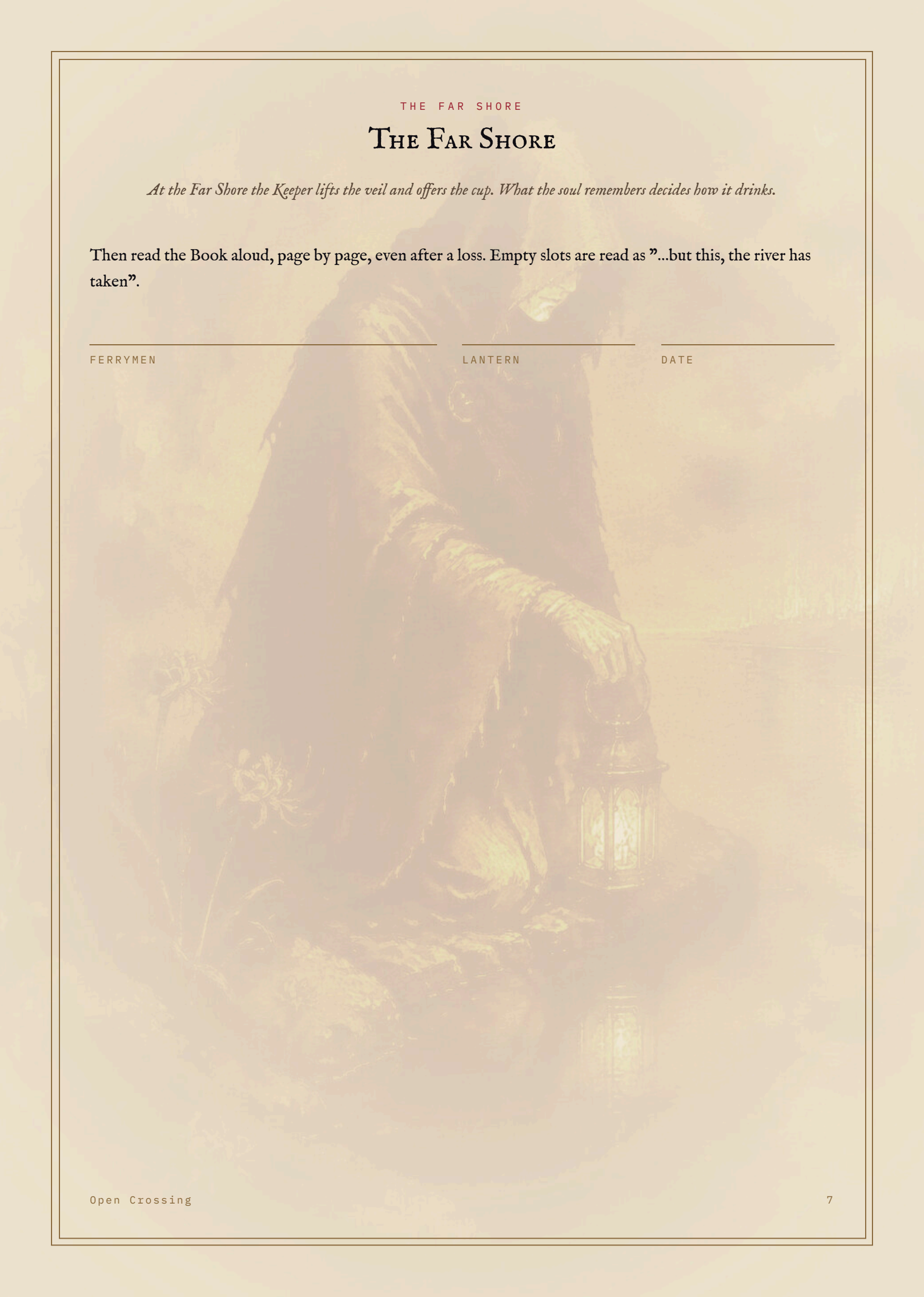
At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page, even after a loss. Empty slots are read as "...but this, the river has taken".

FERRYMEN

LANTERN

DATE





NETHERBLOOM

RALPH LAUXIE